

Problem Statement and Goals Checklist

Spencer Smith

September 24, 2026

- The source for the document
 - ☐ The source is text-based, like $\text{\LaTeX}$, [Markdown](#), [Emacs Org Mode](#), etc.
- Follows [writing checklist](#)
- Overall qualities of documentation
 - ☐ Scope is clear
 - ☐ Document is abstract (for instance, it does not mention the programming language (unless this is a true constraint) or the algorithm choices (unless the algorithm is the “what” rather than the “how”))
 - ☐ Output of software is unambiguous
 - ☐ Inputs to software are unambiguous
 - ☐ Document is simple (for instance, there is no need for a table of contents)
 - ☐ Stakeholders are clearly identified
 - ☐ Environment (for the users) is clearly identified
 - ☐ Importance of the problem is convincingly stated
 - ☐ Goals provide selling features of the product
 - ☐ Goals are measurable
 - ☐ Goals are at the appropriate level; that is, they are not requirements, but higher-level statements that will later be refined into requirements